

ANKUR BAKRE

PENETRATION TESTER | APPLICATION SECURITY

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4.5+ Years Experience **50+** Apps & APIs Assessed **30+** Critical/High Vulns Found **7** Published CVEs

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Penetration tester with 4.5+ years of experience across Application Security, Red Teaming and internal security assessments. Hands-on expertise in web applications security, APIs testing, thick clients. Recognized security researcher with 7 published CVEs and Hall of Fame credits from Apple, Dell, Microsoft, and others for responsible vulnerability disclosure. Exploring AI/LLM security testing through hands-on practice with tools such as promptfoo and Garak, covering prompt injection and jailbreak assessment aligned to the OWASP LLM Top 10 alongside core VAPT work. Delivers clear, risk-prioritized reports that engineering teams and leadership can act on.

KEY RECOGNITION & SECURITY RESEARCH

- ▶ **7 published CVEs** for privilege escalation and stored XSS vulnerabilities in PHPGurukul & WordPress (CVE-2023-27137, CVE-2022-1062, CVE-2022-1063, CVE-2022-1088, CVE-2022-1089, CVE-2022-1094, CVE-2022-1202)
- ▶ **Hall of Fame recognition** from Apple, Dell, Atlassian, Canva, TripAdvisor, CrowdStrike, and others for responsible vulnerability disclosure, including rewarded submissions
- ▶ **Acknowledged by the Government of India (NCIIPC)** for reporting a vulnerability in an Indian government website
- ▶ **Microsoft Security Response Center (MSRC):** Special Mention, Researcher Recognition Program
- ▶ **Winner, MSRC Phishing CTF**, Microsoft BlueHat ASIA, Bengaluru (Nov 2025)
- ▶ **Winner, MSRC Phishing Village CTF**, Microsoft BlueHat, Hyderabad (May 2025)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PENETRATION TESTING: Web Applications, APIs, Thick Client, Active Directory Penetration Testing, Red Teaming, Vulnerability Assessment & Exploitation

AI / LLM SECURITY: AI-Assisted Security Analysis, OWASP LLM Top 10, Prompt Injection & Jailbreak Testing, promptfoo, Garak

CLOUD SECURITY: AWS (IAM & IMDS Misconfiguration Identification, Over-Privileged Instance Role Exploitation)

METHODOLOGIES: OWASP Web Top 10, OWASP API Top 10, OWASP LLM Top 10, PTES

CORE TOOLS: Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, Netcat, Wireshark, Nessus, Sysinternals Suite

ACTIVE DIRECTORY TOOLS: BloodHound, Impacket, Mimikatz, Responder, CrackMapExec, Kerbrute, LDAPSearch

MOBILE TESTING: Drozer, ADB, Jadx, APKTool, MobSF, Frida, Objection

SIEM / BAS: IBM QRadar, Recorded Future, Trend Micro XDR, Cymulate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amdocs Limited | Security Test Engineer

Oct 2023 – Present

- ▶ Lead end-to-end penetration testing across **40+ applications and APIs** for enterprise telecom clients, uncovering **20+ critical and high-severity vulnerabilities** ahead of production release.
- ▶ Identified a critical **AWS IMDS credential exposure vulnerability** (over-privileged EC2 instance role) on a client-managed cloud instance, preventing potential lateral movement and account compromise.
- ▶ Blend automated DAST scanning with manual exploitation to catch business-logic flaws that scanners alone miss.
- ▶ Cover web, API, thick client, and network attack surfaces with Burp Suite, Nessus, and manual techniques tailored to each engagement.
- ▶ Embed security checks into CI/CD pipelines, shifting vulnerability detection earlier into the development lifecycle.
- ▶ Translate findings into risk-prioritized reports, working directly with engineering and client stakeholders through remediation closure.

CLIENT ENGAGEMENTS DELIVERED THROUGH AMDOCS

- ▶ **ELISA (Jan 2026 – Feb 2026):** Performed penetration testing on mainframe applications; managed full vulnerability lifecycle including tracking, retesting, and closure reporting
- ▶ **PLDT AIA EngageOne – One Cloud (May 2025 – Nov 2025):** Conducted web application and API penetration testing; managed defect lifecycle including retesting and closure verification
- ▶ **PLDT SMART – One Cloud (Oct 2023 – 2025):** Performed web application penetration testing for applications migrating to cloud environments; defined testing approach and reporting standards with the client

Vertiv | Engineer, Pentest Analyst

Jul 2023 – Oct 2023

- ▶ Conducted penetration testing across web applications, APIs, and network environments
- ▶ Performed thick client testing and basic firmware analysis to identify security gaps
- ▶ Validated vulnerabilities and supported prioritization and remediation efforts in a fast-paced engineering environment

Persistent Systems Limited | Information Security Analyst (SOC)

Aug 2021 – Jun 2023

- ▶ Delivered **20+ VAPT engagements** across web, mobile, API, and network environments, uncovering **20+ critical and high-severity vulnerabilities** mapped to OWASP Top 10 with clear remediation guidance for development teams
- ▶ Ran mobile application security assessments using Drozer, ADB, Jadx, APKTool, MobSF, Frida, and Objection
- ▶ Simulated real-world attack scenarios using Cymulate (Breach & Attack Simulation) across endpoints, email gateway, and web security controls
- ▶ Monitored security and threat events using SIEM platforms including IBM QRadar, Recorded Future, and Trend Micro XDR
- ▶ **Received the Persistent Systems “High Five” Award (x2)** from the CISO for CERT-In assessment (Stage 3) contributions and VAPT delivery

CERTIFICATIONS

- ▶ Practical Network Penetration Tester (PNPT)
- ▶ Practical Junior Penetration Tester (PJPT)
- ▶ Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH Master)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

International Institute of Information Technology (I2IT), Pune, Savitribai Phule Pune University

ADDITIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

- ▶ Awarded Certificate of Recognition for delivering a critical security project
- ▶ Awarded for Professionalism and Excellence in the One Cloud Program

LANGUAGES

English (Professional) · Hindi (Professional) · Marathi (Native)